

What All the Tests Are Doing

A short, honest explainer of every paper & shadow test — plus the rules, the percentages, and exactly how often it checks — for someone who doesn’t code or trade.

The one thing to understand first

Think of it as a **race between recipes for investing** — run with pretend money. No real dollars are ever at stake. Every “test” is one recipe making daily decisions, and the computer keeps an honest scorecard. The goal isn’t to get rich fast — it’s to find out **which recipe is genuinely worth trusting**, and to admit it when the simplest one wins.

The yardstick

“Just buy the whole market” (S&P 500). If a fancy recipe can’t beat simply buying and holding the whole U.S. stock market, it isn’t worth it. That’s the honest bar everything clears.

The 7 paper tests — recipes that hold pretend positions

Test	What it holds	The question it’s answering
1 · Baseline (the proven one)	Calmer, steadier U.S. stocks	The recipe we already proved works: matches the market with about half the scary drops . Everything else must beat this .
2 · Full Stocks	U.S. stocks, full rulebook	Does all the extra machinery beat the simple Baseline — or just add complication?
3 · Crypto	Bitcoin, Ethereum & large coins	Do the same rules work on crypto?
4 · Combined	Stocks + crypto together	Does mixing them — leaning toward the winner — help, or add noise?
5 · Extra Data	Combined + company filings	Honestly tests data our research said hurts — run anyway to check that live.
6 · + Gold/Silver	Above + precious metals	Does adding a classic safe-haven make the ride smoother?
7 · + Bonds	Investment-grade bonds	Does parking idle cash in bonds (a safer, higher-yield home) earn its place?

Why a race? Recipe 1 is champion. If none of 2–7 beats it over months, the right answer is “keep the simple one.” Proving a complicated idea doesn’t win is a real, valuable result.

The 3 “shadow signals” — advisors that only watch and take notes

These **don’t hold anything and don’t touch the money**. They watch and write down a suggestion or warning each day, so we can later check — honestly, after the fact — whether listening would have helped. They can never act on their own.

Advisor	What it watches	What it's trying to tell us
Fear Gauge (S2)	How nervous the market is vs. how bumpy it's actually been	When people pay up for crash "insurance," history says stocks often do better next. Lean in then?
Weather Report (S1)	Four early-warning gauges across different markets at once	Do other markets together warn us to add or cut stock exposure earlier than stock prices alone?
Watchdog (S6)	The 7 recipes above	Is any recipe quietly breaking down ? It raises a flag for a human — it never changes anything itself.

EXPLICIT DETAIL

The percentages — how much can go where

These are **ceilings, not targets**. The bot is **never required to be invested** — it can sit in 100% cash whenever nothing looks worth the risk. Each slice below is the **most** that can ever go into that basket.

Basket	Most it can hold	Per single pick	In plain terms
Cash	0–100%	—	The safe default. Can be everything.
Bonds	up to 40%	10–20%	Safer, steady, higher-yield home for idle cash.
Stocks	up to 60%	5–8%	The growth engine — but never all-in on one name.
Metals	up to 15%	5–10%	Gold/silver — a small safe-haven cushion.
Crypto	up to 15%	8–12%	Highest risk — kept deliberately small.

The slices don't have to add up to 100% — whatever isn't invested simply stays in cash. "How much of each" also shrinks automatically when markets get risky (see the rules below).

The house rules — the safety habits, every day

Rule	What it means
Cash is always allowed.	If nothing clears the bar, it holds cash. Doing nothing is a valid choice.
Only act if the odds are worth it.	It "buys" something only when the expected gain beats the trading costs.
Read the market's weather.	It sizes down — or goes fully to cash — in bear markets, crises, or wild swings.
Never bet too big.	Hard caps per pick (above), and it uses at most a quarter of the "mathematically aggressive" bet size.
Don't fake diversification.	If its picks are all moving together, it cuts exposure in half.
Automatic brakes (stop-losses).	It freezes / goes to cash if: a total drop hits ~20% , a single day loses ~4% , or it loses 3 days in a row .
Earn trust before going live.	A recipe only graduates to real money after ~90 days of proof <i>and</i> a human sign-off. Nothing is automatic.

How often it checks — the honest monitoring schedule

Read this carefully, because it's where hype usually creeps in. This bot is **not** a second-by-second, watch-the-news-in-real-time machine. It checks and decides **once every weekday, after the U.S. market closes** (around 6:30pm New York time). That is the real cadence — today and when it goes live.

What	How often (real)	Why
Make the day's decisions	Once per weekday, after close	Its signals work on a 1–3 month horizon — daily is the right speed.
Update its models with new data	Every day it runs	Learns from the latest day.
Lean toward what's working	About weekly	Avoids chasing one-day noise.
Full model retrain	Monthly, or if it detects a shift	Fresh but stable.
Watchdog checks for breakdown	Every run	Catches a fading edge early.
Graduate to real money	Only after ~90 days + human OK	Trust is earned, never automatic.

An honest caveat about “real-time” monitoring. The original vision imagined watching news, Reddit, and filings every few minutes. That part is **designed but not built** — today the bot only truly uses **price & volume data, on a daily schedule**. When it goes live (with a paper-trading broker), the decision cadence stays **daily**. We'd rather tell you the plain truth than imply a speed it doesn't have.

The bottom line. Pretend money, honest scorekeeping, strict safety rules, and a daily rhythm. Nothing goes to real investing automatically — it earns it over months against an honest yardstick. The system is built to tell us what actually works, **including when the boring, simple answer is best.**

Generated for the dballage project · paper/shadow testing only · not investment advice.